

FREE WEEKLY STUDY GUIDE

DEVOTION
in Season

WEEK 2 OF 8 · 11 TO 16 OCTOBER 2026

Pressure at Work

How to Handle Pressure Without Compromising Your Faith

SERIES: THE INFLUENTIAL SPIRIT
FOR PERSONAL STUDY, SMALL GROUPS AND TEAMS AT WORK

with Eryeza Kalalu

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This Week at a Glance

This guide goes with Sunday's podcast and the five Devotion in Season Daily episodes that follow it. On your own it takes about twenty minutes. With a small group or a team at work, allow about forty-five. Read the passages slowly, answer honestly, and use the space provided to write down your own limits before the week begins.

Pressure at work shows whether we settled our limits before the test came. Jesus refused the shortcut first and went the way of the cross, and His Spirit gives us the courage to keep our limits.

SUN 11 OCT	Podcast: How to Handle Pressure at Work Without Compromising Your Faith	<i>Daniel 1 · Matthew 4:8-10</i>
MON 12 OCT	When Fear Pushes Your Standards Down	<i>Proverbs 29:25</i>
TUE 13 OCT	How Daniel Handled Pressure	<i>Daniel 1:8</i>
WED 14 OCT	The Hidden Cost of Shortcuts	<i>Galatians 6:7</i>
THU 15 OCT	Telling the Truth When It Costs You	<i>Ephesians 4:25</i>
FRI 16 OCT	A Prayer for Courage Under Pressure	<i>Joshua 1:9</i>

The podcast comes out on Sundays at 8 PM East Africa Time, around midday on the US East Coast. Devotion in Season Daily comes out Monday to Friday at 6 AM East Africa Time, which is the evening before in the United States. Watch or listen on YouTube, Spotify and [eryezakalalu.com](https://www.eryezakalalu.com).

READ

The Passages

“But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king’s delicacies, nor with the wine which he drank; therefore he requested of the chief of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself.”

“Please test your servants for ten days, and let them give us vegetables to eat and water to drink.”

DANIEL 1:8, 12 · NKJV

What it meant first. Around 605 BC, King Nebuchadnezzar of Babylon (in what is now Iraq) besieged Jerusalem and took some of Judah’s brightest young men into exile. Daniel was probably still in his teens. Babylon gave the young men new names, three years of training and food from the king’s table. Scholars differ on exactly why Daniel refused the food; the text does not settle it. What the passage does show is a young man who decided before the test, asked respectfully and offered another way. Verse 2 reminds us that God was at work even in the exile.

“Again, the devil took Him up on an exceedingly high mountain, and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. And he said to Him, ‘All these things I will give You if You will fall down and worship me.’ Then Jesus said to him, ‘Away with you, Satan! For it is written, “You shall worship the LORD your God, and Him only you shall serve.”’”

MATTHEW 4:8–10 · NKJV

What it meant first. Jesus had just been baptised, and the Spirit led Him into the wilderness, where He fasted forty days. The devil offered Him the kingdoms of the world without the cross. Jesus refused that shortcut and went the way of the cross for us. Hebrews 4:15 says He was “in all points tempted as we are, yet without sin,” so we bring our own pressure to a Saviour who understands it.

MY LIMITS

Two or three things I will not do at work, whatever the pressure, and the sentence I will say if I’m asked to.

REFLECT

Five Questions

The questions move from easy to costly. In a group, give people time to answer, and let anyone pass who needs to. Please leave out names when you share stories.

1. Which pressure at work is hardest for you: a target, a deadline or a person? Why that one?
2. Daniel “purposed in his heart” before the test came. What is the difference between deciding in a calm moment and deciding at the end of a long, stressful day?
3. Daniel asked respectfully and offered a ten-day test. When you have needed to say no at work, how did the way you said it affect the outcome?
4. The devil offered Jesus the kingdoms of the world without the cross. What shortcut is offered in your line of work, and what does it promise?
5. Is there a line you have already crossed under pressure? What would it look like to bring it to Jesus, put it right and decide your limits for next time?

THE PRACTICE · ONE ACTION THIS WEEK

Before you start work this week, write down two or three things you will not do at work, whatever the pressure. Under them, write the one sentence you will say if someone asks you to cross that line. Keep the list where you will see it, and ask God for grace to hold to it.

FOUR WISE PATTERNS FROM DANIEL

DECIDE BEFORE

Write your limits down while your mind is calm, and ask the Holy Spirit to hold you to them.

SPEAK WITH RESPECT

Ask for a private word: “I want to help us hit this target, and I can’t do it this way.”

BRING AN ALTERNATIVE

Offer a revised timeline, an honest explanation for the client or extra hours of your own.

LEAVE THE OUTCOME

Sometimes it will cost you. God still watches over the people who honour Him.

If you have already crossed a line, Hebrews 4:16 is for you: “Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy and find grace to help in time of need.” **Your safety matters.** If you are asked to do something illegal, or someone is threatening you, please don’t face it alone. Get counsel, write down what was said and when, and use your organisation’s proper reporting channels or the regulator. If you are in danger, contact emergency services.

GO DEEPER EACH MORNING

With the Daily Episodes

MON

When Fear Pushes Your Standards Down · *Proverbs 29:25*

What fear is most likely to push me to compromise this week? Pray Psalm 56:3: “Whenever I am afraid, I will trust in You.”

TUE

How Daniel Handled Pressure · *Daniel 1:8*

Which one boundary will I decide on today, before anyone asks?

WED

The Hidden Cost of Shortcuts · *Galatians 6:7*

What shortcut am I being offered, and what will it cost later?

THU

Telling the Truth When It Costs You · *Ephesians 4:25*

Which honest conversation have I been putting off, and how can I have it with grace?

FRI

A Prayer for Courage Under Pressure · *Joshua 1:9*

Pray the prayer below over the week ahead, naming each meeting you are dreading.

PRAY

Lord Jesus, You turned down the kingdoms of the world so You could win me on the cross. Thank You. Where I've already given in, I'm sorry. Wash me and set me back on the right path. Holy Spirit, give me a settled heart like Daniel's. When the target, the deadline or the angry voice comes, help me stand with respect and with courage, and go ahead of me into every meeting. In the mighty name of Jesus. Amen.

FROM THE BOOK

Daniel shows up again in Daniel 6, an old man still keeping his line, and Day 17 of *The Influential Spirit*, “An Excellent Spirit,” is built on that chapter. The Formation Bundle adds the audiobook in my own voice, a six-session group study guide and a thirty-day reading plan. All three editions are at eryezakalalu.com, with launch prices until 31 October.

Support this ministry. If this week helped you stand firmer at work, you can help it reach someone facing the same pressure at eryezakalalu.com/give.

Next week: Your work is the sermon. We open Matthew 5:16 and Colossians 3:23–24. The Week 3 guide will be at eryezakalalu.com/study.